



TIPS & TRICKS

View information about the memory and motherboard

Here is a simple command that can provide you with all the details about the memory module installed, along with the capacity and features that the motherboard supports:

```
#dmidecode -t memory
```

Given below is a snippet version of the output of the command:

```
# dmidecode 2.11
SMBIOS 2.6 present.
Handle 0x0032, DMI type 16, 15 bytes
Physical Memory Array
  Location: System Board Or Motherboard
  Use: System Memory
  Error Correction Type: None
  Maximum Capacity: 16 GB
  Error Information Handle: Not Provided
  Number Of Devices: 4
```

—Suresh Jagtap,
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Search for a command's argument from Bash history

There are times when we want to use an argument from the Bash history. Here is a tip that searches the Bash history only for the argument and not the command.

To search, type **ALT** and the '.' (period) key or **ESC** and the '.' (period) key. This will place the argument of the most recent command on the shell.

Here is an example to illustrate the search procedure.

Let's suppose we have opened a file in Vim as shown below:

```
#vi /var/www/wp-content/uploads/2009/03/check.txt
```

Now, if we want to open the same file in *nano*, we only need to type the following command:

```
#nano
```

...and press the **ALT** key and the period '.' This will complete the command with the argument used in the last command:

```
# nano /var/www/wp-content/uploads/2009/03/check.txt
```

Keep pressing **ALT** and '.' to cycle through the arguments of your commands, starting from the most recent to the oldest. This can save a lot of typing time.

—Shivam Kotwalia,
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Recover from Linux application crashes

Sometimes I have faced problems with applications crashing on Linux. Your system hangs and you have no option but to press the power button. Shown below is a simple trick with which you can do a soft reboot of the Linux OS, if the applications you are using hang:

Press these keyboard commands in the order shown:

1. Alt-SysRq-R (Puts the keyboard in raw mode so the kernel can receive commands)
2. Alt-SysRq-S (Puts the hard drive in sync)
3. Alt-SysRq-E (Stops all running processes)
4. Alt-SysRq-I (Kills all remaining processes)
5. Alt-SysRq-U (Unmounts the file system and mounts it in read-only mode)
6. Alt-SysRq-B (Reboots the system)

You must use the left **ALT** key to make this work. After the last command, your PC will restart, and you should be in good shape. We can remember the above sequence with the help of the following riddle:

Raising Skinny Elephants Is Utterly Boring.

Notice that the first letter of the words in the above sentence matches the sequence of commands.

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